MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
THIRD SEMESTER
Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG3VACHBMA00 – ESSENCE OF SERVICE EXCELLENCE

ANSWER – KEY

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Question	Taxonomy	CO	Ans key
1. What does "excellent service" mean to you?	U	CO1	Exceeding expectations, customer satisfaction, attention to detail, consistency
2. How can feedback forms help identify customer touchpoints?	U	CO1	Maps experience, identifies interaction stages, improvement areas
3. Define "customer lifetime value."	K	CO1	Total revenue, long-term relationship, profitability over time
4. Give one example of serving a customer before they even ask.	A	CO5	Anticipating needs, refilling water, proactive assistance
5. Role of a positive attitude in sustaining excellence?	U	CO3, CO5	Motivation, guest satisfaction, teamwork, improves morale
6. Why is looking professional important in hotel and food business?	U	CO2	Builds trust, first impressions, brand image, hygiene
7. Connection between physical comfort and professional demeanor?	U	CO2	Confidence, reduces stress, better communication
8. Significance of clean and polished footwear?	U	CO2	Professionalism, hygiene, positive image, attention to detail
9. Importance of professional boundaries with guests?	U	CO3, CO5	Prevents misunderstandings, maintains respect, avoids conflicts
10. Why set professional boundaries with guests?	U	CO3, CO5	See above (Q9)
11. Why is eye contact important when talking to a guest?	U	CO2, CO3	Trust, engagement, confidence, attentiveness
12. One practical way to build rapport with a customer?	A	CO3	Active listening, using names, personal touch, empathy
13. One common cultural difference in communication.	U	CO3	Gestures, personal space, greetings, eye contact
14. Showing a guest you understand their feelings?	A	CO3, CO5	Empathy, acknowledging emotions, active listening
15. Two rules for good phone manners at work.	K	CO3	Polite greeting, clarity, hold etiquette, cheerful tone
SHORT ESSAY QUESTIONS			
16. Three parts of SERVQUAL model & how they help service.	U	CO1	- Reliability: Consistency in delivering promised services, dependability, error-free performance.

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			- Responsiveness: Promptness in helping customers, quick resolution of complaints, willingness to assist. - Assurance: Staff knowledge, courtesy, confidence building, building trust. - Tangibles: Cleanliness, professional appearance, equipment, physical facilities, visual appeal. - Empathy: Personalized attention, understanding individual needs, caring attitude, approachable staff. - Set service benchmarks, improve customer satisfaction, identify gaps, enable targeted improvements, increase repeat business.
17. Role of continuous training in service excellence.	U	CO1, CO5	- Regular updates, mastery of new techniques, upskilling. - Awareness of industry trends, technology, new regulations. - Uniform standards, reduces errors, improves reliability. - Increased confidence, job satisfaction, retention. - Prepares staff for change, new challenges, diverse customer needs. - Builds rapport among staff, improves service delivery.
18. What is "silent communication" in grooming/appearance?	U	CO2, CO3	- Non-verbal cues: Attire, cleanliness, grooming standards. - Body language: Posture, gestures, facial expressions. - First impression: Immediate impact, sets expectations before verbal interaction. - Professionalism signal: Confidence, respect, attention to detail. - Brand representation: Company image, culture, consistency.
19. How does a positive "first line" in emails set the tone?	U	CO3	- Creates warmth: Friendly greeting, polite salutation. - Sets professionalism: Formal language, clarity from the start. - Invites response: Encourages engagement, feedback, continued conversation. - Reduces misunderstandings: Sets clear expectations, prevents negative assumptions. - Builds rapport: Shows respect, recognition of the recipient.
20. L.A.S.T. method for fixing service problems—when/how to use?	U	CO4	L: Listen A: Apologize S: Solve problem T: Thank customer Use for complaints. Helps fix problems and keep customers happy.

Question	Taxonomy	CO	Ans key
			- When to use: Handle complaints, service failures, negative feedback. - How it helps: Restores trust, prevents escalation, turns negative to positive.
21. Impact of biases on communication with diverse guests.	An	CO3	- Misunderstandings: Stereotypes, assumptions lead to confusion. - Unfair treatment: Discrimination, perceived favoritism. - Reduces satisfaction: Customers feel unwelcome, loss of loyalty. - Limits inclusivity: Hampers open dialogue, weakens relationships. - Action: Awareness, training, sensitivity, feedback mechanisms.
ESSAY QUESTIONS			
22. Ethical issues with service/personal customer info; solutions?	An	CO1, CO5	- Issues: Data privacy violation, unauthorized sharing, misuse of confidential details. - Solutions: Strong privacy policies, staff training, encryption, consent forms, regular audits. - Integrity: Ethical culture, honesty in handling information, reporting breaches. - Importance: Protects customer trust, legal compliance, reputation management.
23. Ethical issues with dress code/grooming vs. self-expression.	An	CO2, CO6	- Dress code necessity: Brand standards, professionalism, hygiene. - Challenge: Diversity, cultural sensitivity, religious expression, comfort. - Balance: Flexible rules, inclusive policies, staff input, respect for individuality. - Example: Allowing cultural attire, considering gender-neutral dress codes, accommodating disabilities.
24. Strategies for saying 'no' gracefully.	A	CO3, CO4	- Polite denial: Positive language, soften the refusal, express regret. - Offer alternatives: Suggest other options, recommend solutions. - Empathetic explanation: Reasoning, show understanding of guest's position. - Active listening: Acknowledge concerns, ensure guest feels heard. - Maintain relationship: Follow-up, express continued support, keep the guest's dignity intact.